Topic 14 — Ancient India Miscellaneous

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

World Civilizations · Civilizations and their Characteristics · Puranas · Materialist Thinkers · Kakatiya Dynasty · Major Rulers of Kakatiya Dynasty · Achievements of Kakatiya Dynasty Taught in that order. World cores start with Mesopotamia, not with the later-famous Harappan city. Kakatiya starts with Chalukya feudatories, not with Rudrama. Historiography books and *Charaka Samhita* (चरक संहिता) sit here because the paper tags them Ancient History and they have no other syllabus home.

Sources baked in: NCERT Themes I, RS Sharma, Puranic genealogies, Kakatiya / Telangana archaeology, UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — Vishnu vs Vayu Purana, Shriparvatiya, Kakatiya–Warangal, book–author, Charaka 120/8 **Last verified:** August 2026 **Current Affairs:** Ramappa Temple = UNESCO World Heritage **2021**.

Books and Writers — Miscellaneous

Book–writer pairs | historiography four + medical samhitas

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
Hindu Polity	**K.P. Jayaswal**	Nationalist gana / polity reading
The Wonder That Was India	**A.L. Basham**	Cultural survey
An Introduction to the Study of Indian History	**D.D. Kosambi**	Marxist / analytical history
The Early History of India	**Vincent Arthur Smith**	Colonial dynastic narrative
Charaka Samhita	**Charaka** (चरक) (Agnivesha redaction)	Internal medicine; **120 chapters / 8 sthanas**
Sushruta Samhita (सुश्रुत संहिता)	**Sushruta**	Surgery / rhinoplasty tradition

- Jayaswal ≠ Smith. Kosambi ≠ Basham.
- **Charaka** = medicine. **Sushruta** = surgery.

Logic: Historiography and Charaka teaching cards continue in the sections below.

14.1 World Civilizations

Four Old World Bronze cores | river surplus first

- A civilization here means cities, surplus grain, specialised crafts, and some form of writing or administration.
- The four cores papers keep matching are **Mesopotamia, Egypt, Indus, Shang China**.
- The four earliest urban cores here are **Bronze Age**. Iron-Age Greece and Rome belong to a later bucket.

Mesopotamia (earliest urban core)

Tigris–Euphrates | Sumer → Akkad → Babylon

- Homeland is the southern Iraq floodplain.
- Greeks named it “land between the rivers.”
- First cities include **Uruk**, **Ur**, and **Lagash**.
- Polity is competing **city-states**, not one Nile-style kingdom.
- Script is **cuneiform** on clay.
- It is the earliest full writing system in the Old World.
- The temple-tower is the **ziggurat**.
- It is a stepped shrine, not a tomb.
- The law fact is **Hammurabi** of Babylon in the eighteenth century BCE.
- That is the “code of Hammurabi.”
- Tech facts include the wheel, the plough, and bronze.
- The epic fact is *Gilgamesh*.
- Sumerian texts call the Indus land **Meluhha**.
- That is the trade name, not a Harappan self-name.

Egypt

Nile | one river, one king

- Regular Nile flood yields grain surplus.
- Polity is a unified monarchy, not Sumerian city-states.
- The king is the **pharaoh**, treated as divine.
- Script is **hieroglyphs**.
- The writing surface is **papyrus**.
- Tombs of the Old Kingdom are **pyramids**.
- The afterlife package includes mummification and the *Book of the Dead*.
- Calendar and survey grew from measuring the inundation.

Indus / Harappan

Indus–Ghaggar | planned cities, unread script

- The Mature phase is about **2600–1900 BCE**.

- It is contemporary with Mesopotamia and Old Kingdom / Middle Kingdom Egypt.
- It is not contemporary with the Gupta age.
- Signatures include grid streets, baked brick, covered drains, and standard weights.
- The Great Bath sits at Mohenjo-daro.
- The script is still **undeciphered**.
- The Harappan script is **still unread** — unlike Egyptian hieroglyphs after Champollion.
- There is no ziggurat.
- There is no pyramid tomb-field.
- There is no named pharaoh.
- Mesopotamia knows this land as **Meluhha**.
- A Harappan seal has turned up in Mesopotamia.
- Lapis comes the other way from Afghanistan.

Shang China

Yellow River (Huang He) | oracle bones

- This is the first historically readable Chinese dynasty, about **1600–1046 BCE**.
- Writing is **oracle-bone** inscriptions on scapula or plastron.
- This script **is** read.
- Elite ritual uses bronze **ding** vessels.
- Ancestor cult sits with the high god **Di**.
- The capital zone is Anyang.
- The chariot appears in elite warfare.

Later buckets (so the paper cannot swap them in)

- **Minoan** Crete uses Linear A, which is unread.
- Its palace fact is Knossos.
- **Mycenaean** Greece uses Linear B, which is early Greek.
- Its forts are citadels.
- **Achaemenid Persia** uses satraps and the Royal Road.
- It is Iron Age, not one of the Bronze four.
- Maya, Aztec, and Inca are New World.
- They use maize.
- They have no Bronze-Age contact with the Indus.

> **Logic:** Garden of Eden in the Bible is conventionally the **Tigris–Euphrates** belt, not the Nile and not the Indus.

14.2 Civilizations and their Characteristics

Same four cores, trait-by-trait | this is the match paper

Trait	Mesopotamia	Egypt	Harappan	Shang
River	Tigris–Euphrates	Nile	Indus–Ghaggar	Yellow River
Polity	City-states → empires	Unified pharaoh	Urban centres, king unnamed	King + clans
Script	Cuneiform (**read**)	Hieroglyphs (**read**)	Indus (**unread**)	Oracle bones (**read**)
Monument	Ziggurat	Pyramid	Great Bath, granaries	Bronze ritual set
Economy	Temple + long-distance trade	Nile grain	Agri + craft + Meluhha trade	Agri + bronze elite
Religion	Many gods, Enuma Elish	Divine king, afterlife	Unresolved (Pashupati debate)	Ancestors + Di
End-note	Conquest replacement	Dynastic continuity	De-urbanisation ~1900 BCE	Zhou conquest

- River surplus is the shared base. Political **form** is not shared: only Egypt has a **pharaoh**; Harappa has no named king.
- Mesopotamia is **temple-centred** and war-prone. Egypt is **tomb-centred** and unusually stable.
- Harappan cities look **corporate**: standard brick, weak palace/temple skyline, few weapons in the record.
- Shang power is **ritual bronze + divination**. The king talks to ancestors through cracks in bone.
- Decline is not one story. Egypt continues. Mesopotamia is conquered in cycles. Harappan cities **thin out** around 1900 BCE.

> **Logic:** “Harappans built ziggurats” is false. “Egypt lived off Nile inundation” is true. “Indus script is read like hieroglyphs” is false.

14.3 Puranas

Smriti encyclopaedias | genealogy is the history use | Gupta-age compilation

- Puranas are **post-Vedic**.
- The main written shape is **Gupta and after**, roughly the fourth to tenth centuries CE.
- They use older oral king-lists.
- The count fact is **18 Mahapuranas** and **18 Upapuranas**.
- A Mahapurana is supposed to carry **panchalakshana**, five marks.

Mark	Meaning
Sarga	Creation
Pratisarga	Dissolution / recreation
Vamsha	Gods-and-sages genealogy
Manvantara	Manu-ages / cosmic cycles
Vamshanucharita	Royal dynasties (the history bit)

- They are **smriti** (स्मृति), not shruti.
- Veda outranks them.
- Use them as a **supplement** to inscriptions, not as a year-perfect chronicle.
- King-lists run long and duplicate names.
- Reign lengths are often inflated.
- Cross-check.

18 Mahapuranas (match list)

#	Purana	Usual sect-tag
1	Brahma	Brahma
2	Padma	Vishnu
3	**Vishnu**	Vishnu — **Mauryan list**
4	Shiva	Shiva
5	**Bhagavata**	Vishnu / Krishna bhakti
6	Narada	Vishnu
7	**Markandeya**	Devi Mahatmya sits here
8	Agni	Encyclopaedic (weapons, vastu)
9	Bhavishya	Mixed / later layers
10	Brahmavaivarta	Krishna
11	Linga	Shiva
12	Varaha	Vishnu
13	**Skanda**	Shiva — largest, tirtha-heavy
14	Vamana	Vishnu
15	Kurma	Vishnu
16	Matsya	Vishnu — flood + dynastic lists
17	**Garuda**	Vishnu — shraddha / afterlife

#	Purana	Usual sect-tag
18	Brahmanda	Brahma

- **Vishnu Purana** (विष्णु पुराण) preserves a **Mauryan** (मौर्य) genealogy. Statement 1 is **true**.
- **Matsya Purana** (मत्स्य पुराण) gives the longest **Andhra / Satavahana** (सातवाहन) king list, about **30** names and about **460** years.
- **Vayu Purana** (वायु पुराण) is used for early dynastic lists, including Gupta **names**. It does **not** give a usable Gupta **system of governance**. Statement 2 is **false**.
- Only statement 1 is correct; both-correct is the bait.

Purana → dynasty (history use)

Six Puranas carry usable Kali-age king-lists: **Vayu, Brahmanda, Bhagavata, Bhavishya, Matsya, and Vishnu**. Those lists usually **end with the Guptas**. Coaching still matches one Purana to one house.

Purana	Dynasty it is asked for	What it preserves
Vishnu Purana (विष्णु पुराण)	**Maurya** (मौर्य)	Maurya genealogy. The same Magadha chain also names Nanda, Shunga, and Kanva.
Matsya Purana (मत्स्य पुराण)	**Andhra / Satavahana** (सातवाहन)	Longest Andhra list, about **30** kings and about **460** years.
Vayu Purana (वायु पुराण)	**Gupta** (गुप्त) *kings*	Gupta **names**. Also the Kanva end and Andhra founder **Simuka** (सिमुक). It is **not** a Gupta admin manual.
Brahmanda Purana (ब्रह्माण्ड पुराण)	Parallel to Vayu	Andhra and Gupta name-lists sit close to the Vayu recension.
Bhagavata Purana (भागवत पुराण)	Solar–lunar lines + Krishna	Also carries Maurya–Andhra lists. It is the Krishna-bhakti peak text.
Bhavishya Purana (भविष्य पुराण)	“Future” Kali-age kings	Later layers. Use it lightly.
Markandeya Purana (मार्कण्डेय पुराण)	Not a dynasty match	*Devi Mahatmya* (देवी माहात्म्य) sits here.
Skanda Purana (स्कन्द पुराण)	Not a dynasty match	Largest Maha. Tirtha geography, not the Magadha king-list.

- Other Puranas can name the same houses. Do not treat the match as “this Purana alone ever mentions them.”

Shriparvatiya

- Puranas call one Andhra line **Shriparvatiya**.
- That line is the **Ikshvakus** of **Vijayapuri / Nagarjunakonda**.
- Sriparvata = the Nagarjunakonda hill. 3rd–4th c. CE. Stupa-and-palace archaeology sits there.

- Trap A is **Vakataka** (Vidarbha–Deccan). Trap C **Shaka**. Trap D **Kharavela** (खारवेल) (Kalinga). Answer **B**.

What is not a Purana

- **Purana Qila** in Delhi is a **fort** name (Humayun / Sher Shah fabric). It is not a Sanskrit text.

> **Logic:** Vishnu Purana = Mauryas only. Shriparvatiya = **Ikshvakus** at Nagarjunakonda. Vayu ≠ Gupta administration handbook.

14.4 Materialist Thinkers

Charvaka / Lokayata | perception only | not the physician Charaka

Indian materialism is the **Charvaka** (चार्वाक) school. Papers also call it **Lokayata** and **Brihaspatya**. Do not confuse it with the physician **Charaka**.

Names and sources

- The putative sutra-author in the tradition is **Brihaspati**.
- Surviving lines are mostly quotations in opponents' books, such as Madhava's *Sarvadarshanasamgraha*.
- The school as a living *matha* **dies out**.
- We meet it as a **refuted** position in Nyaya, Vedanta, and Buddhist texts.

What Charvaka accepts and rejects

- The only **pramana** accepted is **pratyaksha**, direct perception.
- Inference and verbal testimony are rejected as proofs of unseen things.
- There is no lasting **atman**.
- There is no **karma** fruit after death.
- There is no **rebirth**.
- There is no authority of the **Veda** (वेद).
- There is no *yajna* as unseen merit.
- Consciousness is treated as a product of the body.
- The stock image is intoxication arising when ingredients mix.
- Ethics in the hostile summaries say enjoy this world.
- The "debt for ghee" taunt is the quote papers recycle.

Neighbours, not the same school

- **Ajita Kesakambalin** in the Pali canon is a materialist: the person ends at death, four elements scatter. Same family of thought, Buddhist naming.
- **Buddhism** (बौद्ध धर्म) is not materialist. It keeps **karma and rebirth**. It denies a permanent soul, which is a different denial.

- **Nyaya** (Gautama) and **Vaisheshika** (वैशेषिक) (Kanada) are orthodox *darshanas*. They are not Charvaka.
- The correct pair is **Nyaya — Gautama**. Vaisheshika is **Kanada**, not Patanjali. Mimamsa is not Kanada. Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta) is not Kapila (Kapila is Samkhya).

> **Logic:** Charvaka ≠ Charaka. Charaka writes Ayurveda. Charvaka denies the unseen. Mixing the two names is the cheap trap.

14.5 Kakatiya Dynasty

Telangana | 12th–14th c. | capital Warangal (Orugallu)

- They start as **feudatories of the Western Chalukyas**.
- Independence is a twelfth-century story, not an Ashokan one.
- Core land is **Telangana**.
- The belt is Warangal, Hanamkonda, and Karimnagar.
- It is not Uttar Pradesh.
- The early seat is **Hanamkonda**.
- The capital the match-paper wants is **Warangal**.
- Sanskrit and Telugu call it **Orugallu**, the “one-stone” fort.
- Polity uses **nayankara** chiefs.
- They hold land, raise troops, and remit revenue.
- Later Vijayanagara *amaranayaka* looks related.
- Court language is **Telugu** and **Sanskrit**.
- Temple religion is mainly **Shaiva**.
- Delhi arrives twice.
- **Malik Kafur** under Alauddin Khalji takes tribute at Warangal in **1310**.
- The final sack is **1323**, by Ulugh Khan under **Ghiyasuddin Tughluq**.
- The last king is Prataparudra II.
- After 1323 the country passes through Delhi, then Bahmani, then Qutb Shahi Golconda.
- Kakatiya rule itself has ended.

Capital match

Dynasty	Capital
Pallava	**Kanchi** (कांची)
Pandya	**Madura** (Madurai)
Yadava (Seuna)	**Devagiri**
Kakatiya	**Warangal**

- Code on the 2019 paper: A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1 → **B**.
- Swap trap: give Kakatiya **Devagiri**, or Yadava **Warangal**.

Warangal name trap

- Pair **Warangal — Ramchandra Dev** is **NOT** correctly matched.
- **Ramachandra** is the **Yadava** king of **Devagiri** (the man Alauddin squeezed).
- Warangal's last Kakatiya is **Prataparudra**, not Ramachandra.

> **Logic:** Warangal in Alauddin's **conquest chronology** is a **Sultanate** question. The fact here is only: Deccan raid hits **Kakatiya Warangal** after the Rajput forts.

14.6 Major Rulers of Kakatiya Dynasty

Founder-line first | Prola II → Rudradeva → Ganapati → Rudrama Devi

Teach in this order. Prataparudra II is the **last** king, not the founder.

Prola II (early–mid 12th c.)

- Chalukya feudatory who makes the house **stand on its own**.
- Fortifies **Hanamkonda**. Independence phase begins here.

Rudradeva / Prataparudra I (c. 1158–1195)

- Son of Prola II. First to rule as a clear sovereign over a wide Telugu tract.
- **Thousand Pillar Temple** (Rudreshwara) at **Hanamkonda** — consecration tradition **1163 CE**.
- **Rudradeva / Prataparudra I** is the 12th-century male ruler. **Rudrama Devi** is his granddaughter, a century later.

Mahadeva (c. 1195–1199)

- Short reign. Killed in a Yadava clash. The throne then goes to his son.

Ganapati Deva (c. 1199–1262) — peak

- Longest and widest Kakatiya rule. Coast to interior: Godavari–Krishna country.
- Moves the political weight firmly onto **Warangal** fort.
- **Motupalli** (Andhra coast): issues an **abhaya-shasana** — a safety-charter for sea merchants.
- Marco Polo later calls the port **Mutfili**. Keep that foreign-trade fact with Kakatiya Motupalli.
- No son who can hold the line. He settles the succession on his **daughter**.

Rudrama Devi (c. 1262–1289/96)

- Rules as **Rudradeva Maharaja** — male throne-name on grants.
- One of the few **reigning queens** in the Deccan. Not a regent footnote.

- Marco Polo's Andhra "queen" notice is usually tied to her (the identification is the 's working fact, even if a historian may hedge).
- Holds the nayankara chiefs. Dies in the 1290s. Grandson takes over.

Prataparudra II (c. 1296–1323) — last

- Faces Khalji and then Tughluq pressure.
- **1310:** Malik Kafur. Tribute, including the later **Koh-i-noor tradition** (a story, not an inscription).
- **1323:** Ulugh Khan takes Warangal. Dynasty ends. Persian chronicles then scatter his end.

> **Logic:** "Prataparudra founded the Kakatiyas" is false. "Rudrama is a Chola queen" is false. Female monarch + Warangal = **Kakatiya**.

14.7 Achievements of Kakatiya Dynasty

Temples, tanks, thoranas, port charter

Architecture

- Style uses a star or cruciform plan, bracket figures, light porous brick, and a **sandbox** foundation.
- That earth cushion sits under the platform.
- The **Thousand Pillar Temple** at Hanamkonda is a triple shrine of Shiva, Surya, and Vishnu.
- It belongs to Rudradeva in the twelfth century.
- It is **not inside** Warangal fort.
- The **Ramappa (Rudreshwara) Temple** at **Palampet** was built in **1213**.
- The builder-patron is **Recharla Rudra**, a general of **Ganapati Deva**.
- Ramappa "floating bricks" are low-density burnt clay.
- They float on water.
- It became **UNESCO World Heritage** in **2021**.
- The state is **Telangana**.
- It is not Karnataka.
- It is not Andhra after the 2014 split in an option list.

Fort and emblem

- **Warangal Fort**: stone/laterite circuit.
- Four ornamental **Kakatiya thoranas** (gateways). Telangana state emblem uses the thorana.

Irrigation and economy

- Chain-tank country includes **Ramappa Lake** and **Pakhal Lake**.
- A hill-to-field reservoir web sits with them.
- The Motupalli charter is overseas trade under royal protection.
- The diamond hinterland of later Golconda is already in this geography.

- Kakatiya diamonds (Golconda belt) belong to the **Warangal** court, centuries before the Mughals.

Culture

- Telugu court poetry. Vidyanatha's *Prataparudriya* (rhetoric) is a Prataparudra-II fact.
- Palkuriki Somanatha writes Shaiva Telugu works in this world.
- **Perini Shivatandavam**: warrior-Shiva dance later reconstructed and tied to Kakatiya camps.

> **Logic:** Ramappa = Palampet, Telangana, UNESCO **2021**. Thousand Pillar = **Hanamkonda**. Swap those two towns and the question is gone.

14.8 Historiography — four books

Ancient-paper match | four pairs, one code

- *Hindu Polity* is by **K.P. Jayaswal**.
- It is a nationalist reading of ancient *gana* and polity.
- *The Wonder That Was India* is by **A.L. Basham**.
- It is a cultural survey.
- *An Introduction to the Study of Indian History* is by **D.D. Kosambi**.
- It is Marxist and analytical.
- *The Early History of India* is by **Vincent Arthur Smith**.
- It is a colonial dynastic narrative.
- In 2024 List-II the order is 1 Kosambi, 2 Basham, 3 Jayaswal, 4 Smith.
- A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4 keys **C**.
- Option A on that paper (3-2-4-1) swaps Kosambi and Smith.
- That is the bait.

> **Logic:** Basham did **not** write the Marxist introduction. Kosambi did **not** write *Early History*.

14.9 Charaka Samhita

Ayurveda, internal medicine | 120 chapters, 8 sections

- *Charaka Samhita* is the root text of **kayachikitsa**, internal medicine.
- It is a compilation or redaction of the older Agnivesha tradition.
- The rough window is late centuries BCE to early centuries CE.
- The structure fact is **120** *adhyayas* (chapters) in **8** *sthanas* (sections).
- Options 100/5, 80/7, and 60/8 are all wrong distractors.
- The eight *sthanas* need not be recited unless a match-list appears.
- The **count** is what UPPCS asked.

- **Sushruta Samhita** is **surgery**, including rhinoplasty in the tradition.
- It is a different book and a different specialist.
- Charaka is not Vedic shruti.
- It is classical Sanskrit science.
- Charaka the physician is not Charvaka the materialist.

> **Logic:** Correct structure = **120 chapters, 8 sections**. Father-of-Indian-medicine tag in Lucent-type books = **Charaka**.

14.10 Upapuranas — Names and Difference

- There are **18 Upapuranas** (minor Puranas). They are shorter, more local, and more sect-promotional than the Mahapuranas.
- They usually carry a less complete set of **panchalakshana** traits than the eighteen Mahapuranas.
- Coaching lists often name the **Sanatkumara Purana**.
- The **Narasimha Purana** is another frequent Upapurana name.
- The **Durvasa**, **Kapila**, and **Vamana** Upapuranas appear in the same ratta set.
- Further names in coaching dumps include **Bhargava**, **Varuna** (वरुणा), **Kalika**, **Maheshvara**, **Linga**, **Vinayaka**, **Shamba**, **Saura** (सौरा), **Parashara**, and **Maricha**.
- Do not treat an Upapurana title as automatic proof of a full five-trait Mahapurana.

14.11 Ajivika — Neighbour of Charvaka

- The Ajivika order is linked with **Gosala Makkhali** and is contemporary with Mahavira and the Buddha.
- Its doctrine centres on **niyati** (नियतिवाद) (fatalism): everything is predetermined.
- That fatalism is not the same as Charvaka pleasure materialism, which denies lasting soul and unseen fruit.
- Ashoka's **Barabar Hill** caves were donated to Ajivikas — a Mauryan patronage fact, not a Charvaka school card.

14.12 Meluhha Trade — Indus ↔ Mesopotamia

- Sumerian and Akkadian texts name **Meluhha** for the Indus region.
- Coaching export lists from Meluhha include carnelian beads, timber, and ivory.
- Coaching import lists into the Indus world include Mesopotamian metals.
- A Harappan seal found at **Ur** is the standard bronze-age Gulf contact proof.
- Meluhha is a Mesopotamian trade name, not a Harappan self-name carved on every seal.

UP Focus

- No Kakatiya capital, Purana compilation centre, or Bronze-Age core sits in Uttar Pradesh.
- Puranic **Solar/Lunar** genealogies later feed Ayodhya–Prayaga sacred geography. That is a *use* of Purana, not a UP dynasty in this file.
- Ikshvakus of this question are the **Andhra** Shriparvatiya line, not the epic Ikshvakus of Ayodhya.